

Talal Abid Alharbi

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Portfolio: talalalharbi.com | github.com/TalalAlha

Summary

Information Technology graduate (GPA 4.79/5.00, First Class Honors, King Abdulaziz University) specializing in cybersecurity with a strong foundation across development, networking, and security operations. Demonstrated adaptability across technical and leadership roles, from architecting a bilingual phishing simulation platform to engaging 100+ staff and students during KAU's Cybersecurity Awareness Month. Holder of CompTIA CySA+, Security+, and eJPTv2, eager to grow within a structured IT and cybersecurity environment.

Education

Bachelor of Information Technology, King Abdulaziz University
Faculty of Computing and Information Technology

2022 – Jun 2026
Jeddah, Saudi Arabia

- GPA 4.79 / 5.00 - First Class Honors
- Relevant coursework: Networking, Database Systems, Operating Systems, Software Engineering, Information Security, IT Project Management.

Certifications

- CompTIA CySA+ | Jun 2026
- eJPTv2 (Junior Penetration Tester) | eLearnSecurity | Feb 2026
- CompTIA Security+ | Sep 2025

Experience

Information Technology Intern, Deanship of E-Learning, King Abdulaziz University

Jun 2025 – Sep 2025
Jeddah, Saudi Arabia

- Developed a web-based exam room booking system enabling 100+ faculty members to reserve classrooms by required capacity across 15 buildings on KAU's campus
- Collaborated in a 5-person agile team, rotating across frontend, backend, UX/UI, database, and system analysis, delivering a functional booking system within a 3-month timeline.
- Participated in sprint planning and peer code reviews, contributing to iterative development cycles and maintaining code quality throughout the project lifecycle.

Projects

PhishAware | Phishing Simulation & Security Awareness Platform 

- Led a cross-functional development team and worked with academic supervisors to architect a bilingual phishing simulation platform tailored for the MENA region's social engineering landscape aligned with NCA ECC Controls and framework.
- Built a custom AI email generation model from scratch, producing 500+ culturally localised Arabic and English phishing templates aligned to MENA social engineering patterns.
- Engineered a real-time awareness dashboard to track employee susceptibility, click rates, and training completion across corporate departments.

Skills

Security Core: Penetration Testing, Ethical Hacking, Vulnerability Assessment, Cyber Threat Analysis, Network Security, Incident Response, SOC.

Development: Java, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL.

Security Tools: Metasploit, Nmap, Kali Linux, PowerShell, Linux CLI, Nessus, SIEM.

Operations & Networking: GitHub, VS Code, Network Protocols, Firewalls, IDS/IPS, TCP/IP & OSI Model.

Soft Skills: Communication, Leadership, Adaptability, Ambition, Cross-functional Collaboration, Agility, Continuous Learning

Volunteer Experience

Cybersecurity Awareness Month | King Abdulaziz University

Oct 2025

Led a cybersecurity awareness booth during KAU's Cybersecurity Awareness Month (Oct 2025), engaging 100+ students and staff on topics including phishing, password hygiene, and safe digital practices

Languages

Arabic
Native

English
Proficient